2/5/25

The Ball Poem

I Answer the following word meanings:

1 Intrude: To interfere in a place or situation.
sentence I don't want intrude between you two.

2 Epistemology: Greek word 'episteme' meane knowledge.
sentence Epistemology explores how we justify knowledge.

3 harbour: A sheltered area of water where ships dock.
sentence The boats rested safely in the harbour.

4 Desperate: Showing a great need or urgency
Sentence She made a desperate attempt to escape the burning house.

II Reference to Context:

1 "He sense ---------- is external."

a What lesson does the loss of a ball teach the boy?
Ans The loss of the ball teaches the boy that loss is a nature part of life. He realizes that some things, once gone, cannot be recovered, helping him understand responsibility and the importance of moving on.

b What does the ball symbolise in the poem?
(i) boy's mischief (✓)
(ii) boy's anger
(iii) inner sense
(iv) rigidness

C The word 'possesions' in the extinct means _____.

Ans To own or posses something.

III Answer is short Answers:

Q1 At which place was the toy lost? what impact did it have on the boy?

Ans The boy lost his ball in the water near the harbor. As he watched it bounce away and disappear, he felt deep grief and helplessness. This loss taught him a harsh reality – that some things, once lost, cannot be regained. It marked his first experience with responsibility and the inevitable nature of loss in life.

Q2 Why does the poet not wanat intrude on him? what does he suggest?

Ans The poet does not want to intrude on the boy because he believes that experiencing loss is an essential part of growing up. He wants the boy to learn the meaning of loss on his rather than being comforted. Instead of offering him money for a new ball, the poet suggests that the boy must accept loss and take responsibility.

Q3 Why does the poet not offer another toy to the child?

Ans The poet does not offer another toy to the child because he wants him to learn the reality of loss. Instead of replacing the ball, the poet believes the boy should understand some things, once lost, cannot be regained. This lessons helps him develop responsibility and prepares him for future challenges in life.

IV Answer in Long Answers:

Q1 In the poem, the poet teaches the real philosophy of life. What is the philosophy? explain.

Ans The poet John Berryman conveys a profound phylosophy of life – the inevitability of loss and the importance of acceptance. The poem illustrates how the young boy, upon losing his ball, experiences grief and realizes that some things, once lost, cannot be replaced.

The poet does not comfort the boy or offer him a new ball because he wants him to learn a valuable lesson: loss is an essential part of life, and one must learn to cope with it. Through this experience, the boy begins to understand responsibility and the reality that material possessions are temporary. The poem teaches that money cannot compensate for emotional loss, and instead, one must develop resilience and move forward.

This philosophy prepares individuals to face greater losses in life, helping them grow stronger and wiser. The poet emphasizes that learning to stand up after a loss is a crucial part of human existence.

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